

Essential Cheat List - Prompt Engineering Techniques (Only what matters)

1. Give Examples When Needed

- Zero-Shot = No example, just the task.
- One-Shot = Give 1 example.
- Few-Shot = Give several examples (3-5).

Use: To help AI understand the task format.

2. Make the AI Think Step-by-Step

- Chain-of-Thought (CoT)

Use: For math, logic, or anything where the AI needs to explain, not just answer.

3. Guide the AI's Role

- Role Prompting

Use: Tell the AI to act like a lawyer, teacher, doctor, etc. to get answers in the right tone and style.

4. Make the AI Adapt to the Situation

- Instance-Adaptive Prompting

Use: Let the AI give simple or detailed answers depending on how hard the task is.

5. Help AI Be Clearer

- Narrative-of-Thought

Use: When you want the AI to explain like a story or in an easy-to-understand way.

6. Ask AI to Check Itself

- Self-Reflection

Use: Ask the AI to double-check and correct its own answer if needed.

7. Connect Prompts Together

- Context Chaining / Prompt Chaining

Use: Make sure AI remembers past information to answer follow-up questions properly.

Extra Tip:

- Structured Prompt = Ask for answers in bullet points, tables, or step-by-step

Use: When you want consistent, easy-to-read outputs.